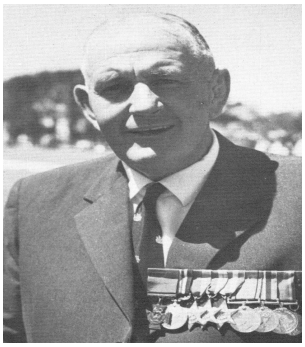


Captain "Toys" Norton, V.C. , M.M.
Royal Hampshire Regiment
Citation for the award of the Victoria Cross

In Italy, on 31st August 1944 Lieut. Norton was commanding a platoon during the attack on the Monte Gridolfo feature, one of the strong points of the Gothic Line defences, and one which contained well-sited concrete gun emplacements. The leading platoon of his Company was pinned down by heavy enemy fire from the valley on the right flank of the advance.

On his own initiative and with complete disregard for his personal safety, Lieut. Norton at once engaged a series of emplacements in this valley. Single-handed he attacked the first machine gun position with a grenade, killing the crew of three. Still alone, he then worked his way forward to a second position, containing two machine guns and 15 riflemen. After a fight lasting 10 minutes, he wiped out both machine gun nests with his Tommy gun, and killed or took prisoner the remainder of the enemy.

Through out these attacks Lieut. Norton came under direct fire from an enemy self-propelled gun and, whilst still under fire from this gun, he went on to clear the cellar and the upper rooms of a house, taking several more prisoners and putting many of the enemy to flight. Although by this time wounded and weak from loss of blood, he continued calmly and resolutely to lead his platoon up the valley to capture the remaining enemy positions.

Throughout the attack Lieut. Norton displayed matchless courage, outstanding initiative and inspiring leadership. By his supreme gallantry, fearless example and determined aggression he assured the successful breach of the Gothic Line at this point.

You will be surprised how much you can achieve by doing your best!